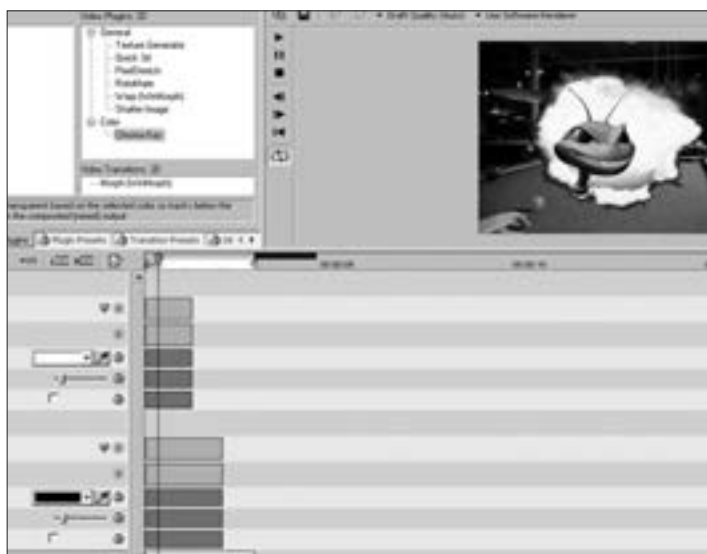




Where did the exploding bug come from?

load it as a new track in the bottom-left panel. Click on the check mark at the right hand side of the item to reveal the track properties, and make sure that the Compositing mode is set to Source Alpha. Simple!

You can also play with different Compositing Modes and see the different effects it can offer you.

If, however, you seem to have video that doesn't come with an Alpha channel (and this will be the case more often than not), you can use a technique called *keying* to get the results you want. When blending actors with computer-generated graphics, movie studios shoot them against a blue or green background, and then “key out” the blue, leaving just the actor and whatever footage they want to place instead of the single-colour background. Alternatively, if you dress your actor in green, and shoot the scene twice—once with and once without the actor, you can make your own “ghost” movie too!